Team Charter — M1

Project name:	MFU Housing Translator (BaanRight) — A Thai Housing Listing Assistant for International Students.
Team name:	16RideRight
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PROBLEM

The problem:	International students at Mae Fah Luang University (MFU) are only guaranteed campus housing for their first year. After that, they must find off-campus housing themselves,but most listings are posted only in Thai and scattered across many different Facebook groups with no central place to search.
Who exactly has it:	International (non–Thai-reading) students at MFU who are searching for off-campus housing after their guaranteed first-year housing ends — not "all students," specifically the subset who cannot read Thai well.
Why it matters / cost today:	Without a clear translation and organized details, students struggle to identify basic facts , price, deposit, location, availability, contact info before comparing options.They currently resort to manually copying each post into Google Translate one at a time, which is slow and easy to give up on, and they have no reliable way to reply to a Thai speaking landlord once they do understand a listing.

GATE 1 — REACHABLE USERS

No.	ROLE	How we reached the users	Date
1.	International student, Software Engineering major, 2nd year, MFU	Found his current accommodation through Facebook housing groups.(currently living on soi 4) He had difficulty understanding Thai-only housing posts and comparing locations between different houses. He also used **Google Translate** to understand the posts. Contacted the landlord through **LINE**, but communicating with the landlord, especially by voice call, was difficult because of the language barrier. He said it was difficult to know which accommodation was closer to MFU when comparing different listings. **How BaanRight could help:** Translate housing posts, extract important information, and make it easier to compare the distance/location of different houses relative to MFU.	26.08.26
2.	International student, Computer Engineering major, 2nd year, MFU	Brother of user #1, he has also searched for and lived in off-campus accommodation. He experienced similar difficulties with Thai housing posts, especially understanding the language and comparing locations. **How BaanRight could help:** Provide English translations, organize important housing details, and help students compare different housing options and their distance from MFU.	26.08.26

3.	International student, Tourism Business & Events major,first year student MFU	She Found her accommodation at Regent Mansion through a **LINE group and a housing agent/broker**. She experienced similar difficulties understanding Thai housing information and comparing accommodation locations. Also experienced difficulties communicating with Thai-speaking landlords. **How BaanRight could help:** Translate Thai housing information, extract key details, and make it easier to compare accommodation options based on location and distance from MFU.	27.08.26

All 3 already face this exact problem themselves (finding off-campus housing at MFU as international students) and are reachable through an existing personal relationship, not a cold approach.

GATE 2 — MVP SHAPE

3–5 planned FRs:	**FR-1 — Input Housing Listing-**As an MFU international student, I want to paste Thai housing-post text into BaanRight, so that I can process the housing information without manually retyping it. **FR-2 — Translate Housing Listing-**As an MFU international student, I want to translate a Thai housing listing into English, so that I can understand the housing information. **FR-3 — Extract and Save Key Housing Information-**As an MFU international student, I want BaanRight to extract and save key information such as price, deposit, location, phone number, and availability, so that I can quickly understand and compare housing options. **FR-4 — Generate Thai Landlord Reply-**As an MFU international student, I want BaanRight to generate common Thai reply messages, so that I can communicate with Thai-speaking landlords more easily. **FR-5 — Translate Selected Webpage Text-**As an MFU international student, I want to translate selected Thai text directly from a webpage, so that I do not have to manually copy and paste housing information into another translator.
Real rule/decision (not CRUD):	**FR-3 —** extracting structured fields from unstructured, informal Thai text requires rule-based pattern matching and a real decision at each field (present vs. genuinely not found, never invented), not a simple create/read/update/delete of a fixed record.
Data that persists between sessions:	**Saved housing listings —** original Thai text, English translation, and extracted fields-stored in the browser's local storage so a student can reopen and compare listings they saved earlier.

GATE 3 — ACCESS

Data / licence / systems depended on:
Cost / licence No paid APIs, accounts, or licences are required for the current MVP.
My Memory Translation API -Free/public service -No API key required for the current prototype -Confirmed working during development
Platform -Google Chrome Extension / Manifest V3 -Used as the platform for BaanRight -Can be loaded and tested as a class prototype
Sample data **Real Thai housing listings** -Collected from MFU-related Facebook housing groups -Team members already have access to these groups -Used for testing the translation and extraction features

PROCESS & TEAM

Chosen SDLC + reason:	**Incremental** — we build and test the highest-risk core features first, especially Thai translation and rule-based housing-information extraction using real sample posts, then add secondary features such as the Thai reply generator and selected-text translation in later increments.